PROJECT REPORT

DIGITAL LITERACY

INTRODUCTION

In today’s digital age, being digitally literate is essential for academic, professional, and personal success. As a Student Digital Ambassador, this project focuses on developing awareness and practical skills required to navigate the digital world effectively and responsibly. The Digital Literacy Portfolio consists of five tasks aligned with different modules of the course, including creating an infographic, building a digital portfolio, exploring platforms, understanding email etiquette, and studying cybercrime awareness. Each task provided hands-on experience with widely used digital tools and platforms. This project not only enhanced my understanding of digital communication and online safety but also helped me build a strong foundation for my professional online presence. Overall, it reflects my learning, observations, and practical application of digital literacy concepts.

Task 1 - presentation

To create this infographic on Digital Literacy, I used Canva, a versatile graphic design tool that allows for a balance of custom illustrations and structured layouts. The platform’s extensive library of vector graphics was essential in maintaining the vibrant, modern aesthetic seen throughout the project

The most interesting part of the process was visual storytelling—trying to represent abstract concepts like "evaluating information" through simple icons. I found it challenging to strike a balance between the artistic, overlapping elements and text readability. Ensuring that the background illustrations didn't distract from the crucial safety contact numbers required several iterations of layering and transparency adjustments.

Task-2-portfolio

For this task, I established a professional digital presence by creating and updating accounts on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. These platforms serve as the foundation for my professional identity in the academic and tech communities. I use GitHub to host my code and collaborate on projects, and I have initialized my profile README with my name, branch, and learning goals. LinkedIn acts as my primary professional networking tool, where I have detailed my current degree and education at VIT Bhopal. Kaggle provides a specialized space for me to practice data science and engage with global datasets.

Over the next four years, I plan to use these tools strategically. I will use GitHub to maintain a transparent history of my technical growth by documenting all my college projects. LinkedIn will be essential for connecting with industry professionals and alumni for internship opportunities. Finally, I will use Kaggle to sharpen my analytical skills through competitions. Together, these platforms ensure I am prepared for the expectations of future employers.

Task-3-Platforms

Part-A Coding Practice

For the technical portion of this module, I utilized HackerRank to strengthen my foundational programming skills. I successfully completed a beginner-level challenge, which required applying logical reasoning to solve a specific computational problem and passing all provided test cases. This experience allowed me to familiarize myself with an industry-standard platform frequently used for technical interviews and competitive coding. By engaging with these automated evaluation tools, I am better prepared for the rigorous technical assessments and coding practice I will encounter throughout my B.Tech degree and future internship applications. Mastering these platforms is a key responsibility for my role as a Student Digital Ambassador, as it enables me to guide my peers toward the right online tools for practicing and improving their technical proficiency.

HackerRank

Task-3-Platforms

Part-B-Google Workspace Collaboration

To demonstrate digital collaboration, I used Google Workspace to create a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" via Google Forms. The form consists of exactly five targeted questions, including at least one multiple-choice and one short-answer question, designed to assess my peers' understanding of safe online practices. I also configured a linked Google Sheet to capture and organize real-time responses effectively. Mastering these cloud-based tools is essential for academic success, as they enable seamless data collection and teamwork on group projects. This exercise was not just a simulation; as a Student Digital Ambassador, I can now use this real deliverable to quiz my batchmates and help them navigate the digital world more responsibly.

TASK-4-EMAIL & ETIQUETTES

PART-A-PROFESSIONAL EMAILS

Email etiquette is a core responsibility to ensure professional communication within the academic and corporate world. Professional emails must always include a clear, concise subject line that allows the recipient to understand the purpose of the message at a glance.

The body of the email should use a professional tone, especially when requesting sensitive items like assignment extensions or expressing interest in competitive internship opportunities. Proper grammar and a polite sign-off, such as "Sincerely" or "Best regards," followed by your full name and registration number, ensure the communication remains professional.

TASK-4-EMAIL & ETIQUETTES

PART-B-ETIQUETTES

In the professional world, a single poorly drafted email can lead to significant consequences, as seen in a hypothetical scenario where a student requests an assignment extension. In this case, the student sent a last-minute, informal message with no subject line, failing to include their registration number or a valid reason for the delay. The professor, overwhelmed by emails, ignored the message due to its unprofessional tone and lack of clarity, resulting in the student missing the deadline and failing the module.

To avoid this, the student should have applied professional digital etiquette. They could have sent the email well in advance with a clear subject line like "Extension Request - [Name] - [Reg No]". Using a formal greeting and a well-structured body to explain the situation would have maintained a respectful tone. This approach demonstrates that a short, correctly structured email is far more effective than a long, disorganized one.

TASK-5-CYBERCRIME

1. .What Surprised Me

The most surprising realization was the fragmented nature of identity theft. It isn’t always a single "Hollywood-style" hack that drains a bank account. Often, it is the "mosaic effect"—where small, seemingly public snippets of information (a birthdate from social media, a partial address from a discarded shipping label, or a phone number from a "loyalty" sign-up) are stitched together by bad actors to impersonate someone or bypass security questions.

2.One Habit I Will Change

I will adopt the habit of strict data minimization. This means intentionally leaving non-mandatory fields blank on digital forms and being more "digitally stingy" with my personal details. Instead of treating my data as a currency for convenience, I’ll treat it as a locked asset, only providing the absolute minimum required for a service to function.

CONCLUSION

The completion of this project marks a significant milestone in bridging the gap between technical proficiency and digital responsibility. Through a structured, multi-task approach—ranging from the initial setup of professional platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn to the deep-dive analysis of cybercrime in Task 5—this initiative has evolved into a comprehensive framework for navigating the modern internet. A central focus of this project was the pervasive threat of Identity Theft, illustrating how fragmented pieces of personal data can be harvested and reconstructed by bad actors to compromise a user's entire digital persona.

By developing interactive awareness tools like the Google Forms quiz and the Digital Safety Infographic, the project moved beyond theory to provide tangible value to the community. The core takeaway is that digital literacy is not a static skill but a continuous practice of skepticism, data minimization, and proactive security. As I move forward, the professional accounts and the prevention guides created here will serve as a foundation for a secure, impactful digital presence. This project confirms that while technology will always evolve, a well-informed and cautious user remains the most effective defense against the complexities of identity-based fraud in the digital age.

REFERENCES

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- 4 GitHub Docs, "Best Practices for Code Security and Professional Documentation," 2026